Since independence, and much more so over the past two decades, India has developed robust development partnerships with many African countries. India has contributed to building their public institutions, imparting professional training, and providing development assistance. The most recent aspect of India's interaction with Africa has been accelerated provision of a concessional interest rate through lines of credit operated by the Export-Import Bank of India extended to African borrowers for the import of goods from India. The countries of the Persian Gulf are important for India's energy security as hosts of a very large number of expatriate Indian workers, as export markets for Indian goods, and as potential investors. According to the 2019 edition of the *Global Energy Outlook*, published by the Vienna-based International Energy Agency (IEA), 80 percent of international oil trade will be in Asia in 2040, in large part by a doubling of India's import needs. Among emerging economies, India's energy requirement is projected to grow faster than in any other country. IEA suggests that India's oil consumption will grow faster in the coming two decades than that of any other major economy, with its demand for energy set to double by 2040.[23] Since most of India's petroleum products are imported from the Persian Gulf, the importance of the region to India is self evident.

Prime Minister Modi's speech at the Shangri-La Dialogue on 1 June 2018 clearly mapped India's interest in the Indo-Pacific.[24] In the speech, he said that the entire region must rise above its divisions and competition to work together toward common objectives. He called for unity, cohesion, freedom, openness, and inclusiveness. Stating that "India does not see the Indo-Pacific region as a strategy or a club of limited members," he was indirectly inviting interested countries, including China and Russia, to be part of the Indo-Pacific, and he clarified that the Indo-Pacific is a positive construct and not "directed against any country." It is interesting that a few days after his talk, Indian newspapers